

warranty. The VIP 400W SMPS from Kunhar peripherals costs Rs 2k with a three-year warranty.

Q I have an AMD Athlon XP 1.7 GHz with a Gigabyte 7A2mmh motherboard, a 40 GB HDD, 256 MB of SDRAM and GeForce4 MX 440 graphics card. Is this sufficient for playing all PC games, or do I need to buy a better graphics card? And for a new card, will I need to change the motherboard?

Murtuza Madraswala

A The GeForce4 MX series card can run most games; in fact, *Doom 3* and *Half-Life 2* also run on these cards, but at extremely low settings and without any special effects. You don't need to upgrade your motherboard if you are settling for an AGP 8X card, since these are backward-compatible. If you are a gamer, I suggest you stall your graphic card purchase for the moment.

The reason is that all upcoming games will be more demanding in terms of CPU power and memory resources, and your processor can be a real bottleneck. Your current system will easily bog down with the demands of a high-end game, even with a new AGP card. Your only solution would then be to upgrade your entire rig. However, all new motherboards will soon start sporting PCI Express slots, making your brand-new AGP card obsolete! I'd suggest you change your entire rig when PCI Express enters the mainstream.

Q I am interested in recording some of my favourite TV programmes available via the TV cable connection at home.

V K Narayan

A Install a TV-tuner card in your PC, and it should help you record your favourite TV programmes without any fuss. TV-tuner cards from vendors such as Pinnacle and Compro are quite expensive, generally in the range of Rs 2,450 and Rs 3,925 each.

While the Pinnacle is just a TV-tuner card, Compro's Videomate TV gold is a graphic card cum TVtuner card. Pixelview